



BSc (Hons) in **Information Technology**
Specialized in AI
IT3012 : Intelligent Agents

Year 3 · Semester 1 · 2026 Semester 2

Faculty of Computing

Practical 02

Objective & Lecture Mapping: In Lecture 03, we learned that a mathematically perfect "Table-Driven Agent" is impossible to build due to combinatorial explosion. Instead, we must write Agent Programs. Today, you will implement a **Simple Reflex Agent** using Condition-Action rules, observe its fatal flaws in a partially observable environment, and then upgrade it to a **Model-Based Agent** that maintains an internal memory state.

Part 1: Practical Implementation — Coding the Architectures

Step 1.1: Setting the Trap (Partial Observability)

To see why Simple Reflex agents fail, we must handicap your agent's sensors. We are moving from a Fully Observable world to a Partially Observable one.

1. Open your `visual_grid_game.py` from Lab 01.
2. Locate the `get_percept(self)` method.
3. Modify it so it **no longer returns** the exact global coordinates (`agent_pos`). Instead, it should only return local booleans, e.g., `{ 'wall_ahead': True/False, 'food_here': True/False }` based on checking the adjacent cell in its current facing direction.

Step 1.2: The Simple Reflex Agent (Implementation & Failure)

1. Create a new class called `SimpleReflexAgent` .
2. Implement a `sense_and_act(self, percept)` method that uses strictly IF-THEN logic (Condition-Action rules). *Do not use an `__init__` method to store history.*

Example Logic: IF food_here THEN suck; IF wall_ahead THEN turn_left; ELSE move_forward

3. Run the simulation. **Observe:** Watch the agent get trapped in a corner or a U-shaped wall, infinitely repeating a cycle (e.g., turn left, step forward, hit wall, turn left...).

Step 1.3: The Model-Based Agent (Memory & State)

1. Create a new class called `ModelBasedAgent`.
2. Implement an `__init__(self)` method to initialize an internal memory state (e.g., `self.visited_cells = set()` or a relative movement tracker).
3. In `sense_and_act(self, percept)`, first **update the state** (Transition & Sensor Model) by recording the current percept and the last action taken.
4. Update your IF-THEN rules to query the memory.
Example Logic: IF wall_ahead AND left_is_visited THEN turn_right
5. Run the simulation. **Observe:** The agent should now remember where it has been, realize it is in a loop, and choose an alternate path to escape.

Part 2: Theoretical Evaluation & Lecture Mapping

Based on your practical observations above, answer the following questions to map your code directly to the architectural theories covered in Lecture 02.

1. (Remember) According to Lecture 02, why is it impossible to program a mathematically perfect "Table-Driven Agent" for complex environments like Chess? What happens as the agent's lifetime increases?

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It is impossible because of combinatorial explosion. A Table-Driven Agent needs an entry for every possible percept sequence. In complex environments like Chess, the number of possibilities is extremely large. As the agent's lifetime increases, percept sequences grow exponentially, requiring an impossible amount of memory and time.

2. (Understand) Look at the code you wrote for your `SimpleReflexAgent` . Identify and explain the specific lines of code that represent the "Condition-Action Rules" discussed in the lecture.

In agent.py, the Condition-Action rule is:

```
if percept.get('wall_ahead'):
    turns = {'Up': 'Right', 'Right': 'Down',
            'Down': 'Left', 'Left': 'Up'}
    return turns[facing]
return facing
```

This follows an IF-THEN rule: IF wall_ahead is True, THEN turn 90 degrees. ELSE, continue moving forward.

3. (Analyze) Your `SimpleReflexAgent` likely got stuck in an infinite loop during Step 1.2. Based on the lecture, analyze exactly why this happened. How did the combination of "Partial Observability" and a lack of "Percept History" cause this failure?

Because the environment is partially observable, the agent only sees the immediate area and cannot see the whole maze. A Simple Reflex Agent has no memory, so it makes decisions only from the current percept. When it gets stuck near a wall or corner, it repeatedly receives the same percept such as wall_ahead = True and performs the same action. Since it cannot remember previously visited places, it can enter an infinite loop.

4. (Evaluate) In Step 1.3, you added an internal state to your `ModelBasedAgent` . Evaluate how your specific code handles the "Transition Model" (how the world evolves) and the "Sensor Model" (how the agent's actions affect the world).

In ModelBasedAgent, the internal state is stored using self.current_relative_pos and self.visited_relative_cells.

The Sensor Model uses information from the agent's previous action and current percept to update its relative X/Y position.

The Transition Model represents the rules of the grid world. If the agent tries to move but receives hit_wall = True, it understands that the movement failed and reverses the coordinate update. This keeps its internal map accurate and allows it to detect visited cells and avoid loops.

Finalize and Lock Lab 02 Documentation



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